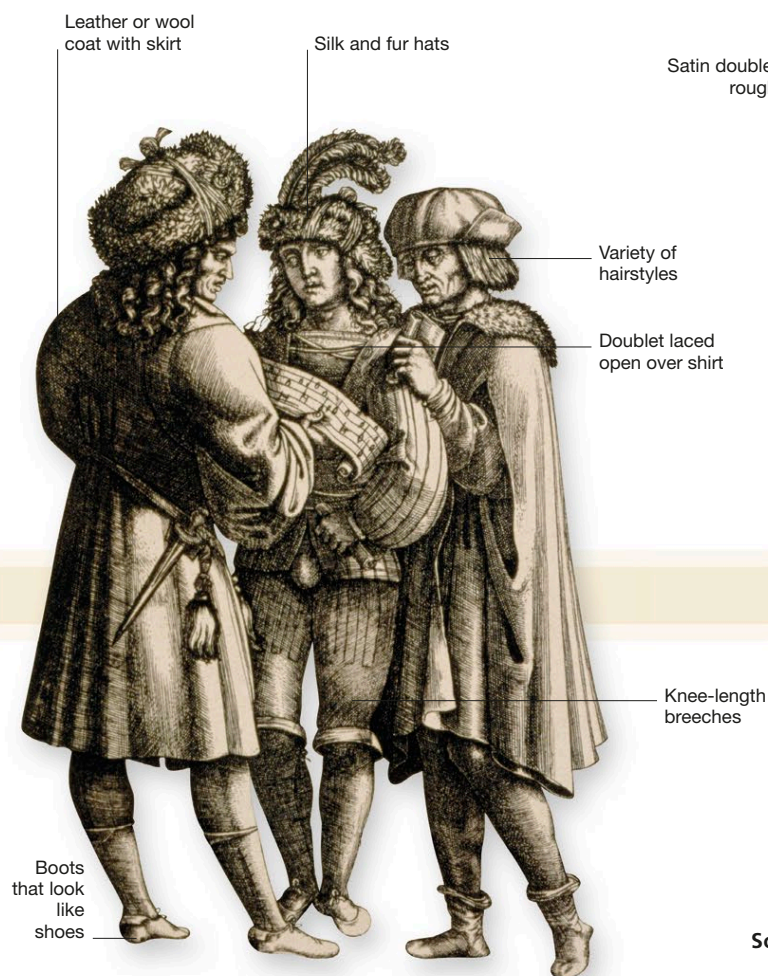


1500–1560

NEW MEN IN A NEW WORLD

As conquest, exploration, and wars expanded the known world, men's fashion broadened too. Clothing expressed an assertive, confident masculinity through bulky layers that increased a man's physical presence. Huge shoulders, broad chests, prominent codpieces, and an emphasis on the thighs all enhanced a sense of the active body. The legs usually peeped out below knee-length skirted robes and jerkins and the newly separate breeches and hose. Clothing complexity increased as linings and shirts burst through deliberately cut and slashed outer garments. Embroidery and lines of braid also helped enrich the surfaces of clothing, largely replacing patterned textiles.



Three layers of men's dress These early 16th-century Italian musicians wear a big-sleeved doublet and hose (centre), a bulky coat with a separate skirt cut on the circle (left), and, over the whole, an armhole cloak with fur collar (right).



Solid, square silhouette Holbein the Younger's 1533 portrait of a French ambassador epitomizes the fashionable solid, rectangular shape. Round puffed sleeves create massive shoulders, while the lines of his cap, skirt, shoes, and spread-out pose all emphasize the horizontal.